

The Garden Keeper - Plant Care Cheat Sheet

Print this and keep it near your plants

Watering Rules

- Succulents: water only when soil is completely dry - usually every 2-3 weeks.
- Pothos / philodendron: water when top 2 inches of soil feel dry.
- Ferns: keep soil consistently moist, never soggy.
- Cacti: monthly in summer, almost none in winter.

Overwatering kills more plants than underwatering. When in doubt, wait.

Light Guide

- Direct sun: cacti, succulents, citrus, most flowering herbs.
- Bright indirect: pothos, monstera, philodendron, spider plants.
- Low light: snake plants, zz plants, ferns (with humidity).

Leggy pale leaves = need more light. Brown crispy = too much.

Common Problems

- Yellow lower leaves = overwatering or root rot.
- Yellow new growth = nutrient deficiency.
- Brown crispy tips = low humidity or bad water.
- Drooping = check soil: wet = overwatered, dry = underwatered.
- No growth for months = root bound, dormant, or low light.

Fertilizer Schedule

- Spring + Summer: feed every 2-4 weeks with diluted liquid fertilizer.
- Autumn: reduce to half strength once a month.
- Winter: stop fertilising - most plants are dormant.

Always fertilise damp soil, never dry roots.

Propagation Quick Wins

- Pothos: cut below a node, root in water, transplant after 2 inches of roots.
- Spider plants: plant baby plantlets directly into moist soil.
- Succulents: let leaf cuttings callous for 2 days, then lay on dry soil.

Repotting Signs

- Roots growing out of drainage holes.
- Water runs straight through the pot (root-bound).
- Plant dries out within 1-2 days of watering.
- Best time to repot: spring, just before active growth.

